

INDUSTRIALISATION, EMPIRE & POWER

Britain's Transformation from Agrarian Kingdom to Global Workshop (1750–1901)

OVERARCHING HISTORICAL ENQUIRY

“How did 19th-century Britain transform at home and abroad?”

8 CORE ENQUIRIES



Primary Visual Source: *Imperial Federation: Map of the World Showing the Extent of the British Empire in 1886* Illustrated by Walter Crane (1845–1915)

CURRICULUM SYNOPSIS • THE DUAL REALITY OF THE INDUSTRIAL AGE

Steam engines shrieking in smoke-choked valleys, coal-fired textile mills grinding night and day, and an island kingdom projecting naval power across a global empire upon which the sun never set. In this unit, pupils interrogate the dual reality of Britain's Industrial Revolution: revolutionary engineering and technological mastery built alongside the brutal transatlantic trade in enslaved human beings, deadly urban squalor, and the struggle for working-class democracy.

THE 8 DISCIPLINARY ENQUIRIES:

L1: Energy, Steam & Henry Cort

L5: Empire & 1857 Indian Rebellion

L2: Factory Labour & Discipline

L6: Peterloo & Working-Class Protest

L3: Town Slums & Chadwick (1842)

L7: The 1832 Great Reform Act

L4: Navy & Expansion of Empire

L8: The Standard of Living Debate

PUPIL NAME: _____

CLASS: _____

PROGRESS & ASSESSMENT TRACKER

Target Grade: _____

Level	Emerging (1-2)	Emerging+ (3)	Expected (4-5)	Expected+ (6-7) / Greater Depth (8-9)
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Lesson / Assessment Title	Effort	Level	Teacher Comments
L1: What powered the Industrial Revolution, and how did a Fareham ironmaster change the world?			
L2: Was industrial work progress or punishment?			
L3: Did industrialisation make British towns unlivable?			
L4: How was the British Empire built and sustained?			
L5: How did the Empire strike back? The 1857 Indian Rebellion			
L6: How did ordinary people fight for a voice?			
L7: How did the road to democracy expand?			
L8: Who truly benefited from 19th-century transformation?			
Assessment: End of Unit Assessment: Industrialisation & Empire			
Final Unit Grade:			

CURRICULUM ROADMAP & CHRONOLOGICAL SPINE

1750 – 1900

Follow Britain's dual transformation: the domestic industrial revolution at home and the expansion of imperial power abroad.

1769–1784

The Energy & Materials Revolution

Watt patents separate steam condenser (1769); Cort patents puddling & rolling at Funtley (1783–84).

1780–1830

The Rise of the Factory System

Water frames and steam looms concentrate workers into textile cities; domestic system collapses.

1815–1819

Post-Napoleonic Distress & Peterloo

Corn Laws spark starvation; 60,000 peaceful reformers charged by cavalry at St Peter's Field (1819).

1832–1848

The Struggle for Parliamentary Voice

Great Reform Act enfranchises middle class (1832); Chartists present million-signature petitions (1838–48).

1842–1858

Urban Crisis & Public Health Reform

Chadwick exposes slum death rates (1842); King Cholera epidemics lead to the Great Stink & Bazalgette (1858).

1857–1858

The Indian Rebellion & Crown Rule

Uprising in Meerut shatters East India Company control; Queen Victoria assumes direct Crown sovereignty (1858).

1870–1900

High Imperialism & The Global Balance Sheet

Scramble for Africa; Victorian cultural propaganda contrasts against domestic working-class inequality.

Hampshire Local History Connection:

Our curriculum directly anchors national events into our local Hampshire landscape: from **Henry Cort's surviving puddling weir and iron slag wall at Funtley**, to **Fareham Red brick clay pits**, and the **Portsmouth Royal Navy Dockyard** industrial complex.

Turn overleaf to begin Lesson 1 (Pages 4–5 Facing Spread) →

L1: What powered the Industrial Revolution, and how did a Fareham ironmaster change the world?

CORE LEARNING OBJECTIVES:

- Explain how coal and Watt's steam engine replaced the domestic system and water power.
- Analyse how Henry Cort's puddling and rolling processes at Funtley transformed brittle pig iron into tough naval wrought iron, evaluating surviving physical archaeology along the River Meon.
- Evaluate the relative importance of Portsmouth Dockyard's location versus technological genius in Cort's success.

DO NOW: RECALL

Score: / 5

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CORE VOCABULARY

Distinguish between brittle **pig iron** (high carbon content) and tough naval **wrought iron** (refined by Cort at Funtley):

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TASK 4: DRAW & LABEL HENRY CORT'S PUDDLING FURNACE & GROOVED ROLLERS (1784)

Sketch the furnace and rollers in the box below, then label the 4 key parts:

- ① **Firebox** (keeps coal separate from iron) • ② **Arched roof** (bounces heat down onto iron) • ③ **Puddling bar** (worker stirs out carbon) • ④ **Grooved rollers** (squeezes out impurities)

Low-Floor Clue: Notice how the coal fuel never touches the iron directly—only the heat melts the metal, keeping it pure and strong.

★ **Scholar's Edge:** Why did Britain's ability to mass-produce coal-fired wrought iron give it a huge naval advantage over France?

Enquiry: How significant was Henry Cort’s puddling process to British industrial and naval supremacy?

EXTENDED WRITING

1. IMMEDIATE IMPACT

Explain how Cort’s puddling furnace and grooved rollers boosted British iron production 15 times and stopped Britain relying on foreign iron.

2. LONG-TERM CHANGES

Explain how cheap, strong iron changed Britain over time—making it possible to build steam engines, railways, and iron warships.

3. OVERALL JUDGMENT

Give your final judgment: was Cort’s breakthrough the main reason Britain became an industrial power, or were coal and steam more important?

Sentence Starters & Connectives: The immediate breakthrough was... • Over time, this changed Britain because... • Crucially, this transformed... • In terms of importance... • Overall, Cort was significant because...

[P] Point: Clear sentence answering enquiry.

[E] Evidence: Specific facts from Page 4.

[E] Explanation: Explain how and why this happened.

[L] Link: Link back to answer the question.

Handwriting practice lines consisting of 20 horizontal blue lines.

Teacher Assessment: Effort: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4] | Subject Knowledge: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4] | Disciplinary Analysis: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4]

PEEL Mastery: [] P [] E [] E [] L

- Explain how steam-powered factories replaced domestic handcraft with machine discipline and child exploitation.
- Analyse how the Fareham Red Brick Boom connected local Hampshire clay pits to national imperial architecture like the Royal Albert Hall.
- Evaluate whether the Industrial Revolution was primarily human punishment or societal progress using the Optimist vs. Pessimist debate.

Score: / 5

Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Q5
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Write one historically accurate sentence connecting the mechanised **pug mill** to the mass production of durable **Fareham Red bricks**:

Complete the two-column ledger below, contrasting the factory owner's argument for progress against the worker's lived reality.

- Higher cash wages compared to agricultural farm work.
- Production of cheap, machine-made clothes and iron goods.
- Steam-powered machines producing far more goods than hands.
- Fewer seasonal famines and better trade between towns.

 Synthesise their perspective in 2–3 sentences:

[illegible]

- 14-hour work days strictly ruled by the factory clock.
- Widespread child labour in Hampshire clay pits and mills.
- Terrible accidents: lost fingers, broken bones, and lung disease.
- Loss of independence and family time at home.

 Synthesise their perspective in 2–3 sentences:

[illegible]

Enquiry: Was industrial work a triumph of human progress or a catastrophe of punishment for the working class?

EXTENDED WRITING

1. WHAT CHANGED?

Explain how daily life changed when workers moved from cottage farming to long hours ruled by the factory clock and loud machines.

2. WHAT STAYED THE SAME?

Explain what stayed the same: dangerous physical work, long shifts, and children working hard in brickworks and textile mills.

3. WAS IT PROGRESS?

Give your judgment: did cheaper goods and higher national wealth make up for the harsh and dangerous working conditions?

Sentence Starters & Connectives: A major change for workers was... • However, conditions stayed the same because...
• On the one hand... • On the other hand... • Overall, I judge that...

[P] Point: Clear sentence answering enquiry.

[E] Evidence: Specific facts from Page 6.

[E] Explanation: Explain how and why this happened.

[L] Link: Link back to answer the question.

Handwriting practice lines consisting of 20 horizontal blue lines.

Teacher Assessment: Effort: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4] | Subject Knowledge: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4] |
Disciplinary Analysis: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4]

PEEL Mastery: [] P [] E []
[] E [] L

- Explain how rapid urbanisation, back-to-back housing, and cesspools created lethal conditions in industrial cities.
- Analyse how King Cholera and the 1858 Great Stink shattered laissez-faire ideology, leading to Bazalgette's sewer network.
- Evaluate the historical debate between Optimists and Pessimists regarding the living standards of the Victorian working class.

Score: / 5

Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Q5

Complete the summary below using the terms *Miasma Theory* and *Laissez-faire*:

Victorian authorities refused to fund municipal sewers due to their doctrine of [], wrongly assuming cholera spread via [].

Application: Explain why Chadwick's 1842 Report challenged both assumptions:

1. Underline the shocking statistical comparison Chadwick uses to provoke Parliament.
2. In the lines below, explain why an historian must consider Chadwick's motive when judging the accuracy of these figures:

“The annual loss of life from filth and bad ventilation are greater than the loss from death or wounds in any modern war. In the cellar dwellings of Manchester and Leeds, human excrement oozes through walls, and whole families sleep upon damp dung. The average age at death of the working class in Manchester is 17 years, compared to 38 years for the rural gentry.”

Page 8 of 20

Enquiry: How useful is Edwin Chadwick's 1842 Sanitary Report for investigating living conditions in Victorian industrial towns?

- Explain how mercantilist trade networks and the East India Company extracted wealth and raw materials.
- Analyse how Portsmouth Royal Dockyard and steam industrial technology sustained the Royal Navy's global supremacy.
- Evaluate the impact of British imperial rule on colonized peoples, contrasting corporate profits with indigenous de-industrialisation.

Score: / 5

Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Q5

Distinguish between corporate commercial expansion (**East India Company**) and state naval deterrence (**Two-Power Standard**):

Complete the comparative analysis below evaluating the two main drivers of British imperial expansion.

Dimension	The Royal Navy (Portsmouth Complex)	Chartered Trade (East India Company)
Strategic Purpose	Global command of sea lanes & military deterrence.	Commercial extraction of silk, spices, tea & opium.
Key Mechanism	Industrial dockyards, steam frigates, global coaling.	Private corporate armies, tax collection (Diwani).
Vulnerability	Massive state tax burden & naval timber shortages.	Corporate corruption & indigenous armed rebellion.

Synthesis: In 3–4 sentences, explain which pillar was more essential for maintaining global dominance between 1750 and 1850:

Enquiry: Was the expansion of the British Empire primarily driven by naval military power or commercial profit?

EXTENDED WRITING

1. WARSHIPS & NAVAL POWER

Explain how the Royal Navy and dockyards like Portsmouth helped Britain conquer lands, guard trade routes, and defeat rivals.

2. TRADE & MAKING MONEY

Explain how merchants and companies like the East India Company expanded the empire to make huge profits from tea, spices, and textiles.

3. WHICH MATTERED MORE?

Give your judgment: was the British Empire built mainly by military warships, or was the search for trade and profits more important?

Sentence Starters & Connectives: The Royal Navy was vital because... • At the same time, trade drove expansion because... • However, without warships... • Overall, the main driving force was...

[P] Point: Clear sentence answering enquiry.

[E] Evidence: Specific facts from Page 10.

[E] Explanation: Explain how and why this happened.

[L] Link: Link back to answer the question.

Handwriting practice lines for the extended writing section.

Teacher Assessment: Effort: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4] | Subject Knowledge: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4] | Disciplinary Analysis: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4]

PEEL Mastery: [] P [] E [] E [] L

L5: How did the Empire strike back? The 1857 Indian Rebellion

CORE LEARNING OBJECTIVES:

- Explain the deep structural grievances (Doctrine of Lapse, taxation) and immediate spark (Enfield rifle) of the 1857 uprising.
- Analyse the major turning points, including the capture of Delhi, the leadership of Rani Lakshmibai, and the brutality of reprisals.
- Evaluate the historiographical debate between colonial British and modern Indian interpretations of the rebellion.

DO NOW: RECALL

Score: / 5

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CORE VOCABULARY

Write one historically accurate sentence connecting Dalhousie's **Doctrine of Lapse** to the grievances published in the **Azamgarh Proclamation**:

TASK 4: INTERROGATING THE REBEL MOTIVATION: THE 1857 AZAMGARH PROCLAMATION

1. Underline the economic and religious grievances listed by the rebel leadership.
2. In the lines below, explain what this proclamation reveals about the diverse groups uniting against British rule:

“Both Hindus and Muslims are being ruined under the tyranny and oppression of the treacherous English. The British have subverted our religion, impoverished our artisans with foreign machine goods, and dispossessed our ancient landed nobility. Arise, then, and rally under the Imperial banner to defend your faith and ancestral lands!”

Low-Floor Clue: Look at who is addressed—is this just soldiers complaining about rifle grease, or something much broader?

Enquiry: Explain the sequence of events that transformed a military mutiny in Meerut into the 1857 Indian Rebellion.

EXTENDED WRITING

1. WHY ANGER BOILED OVER

Explain why people in India were angry: the British taking over kingdoms and soldiers fearing greased cartridges offended their religion.

2. HOW THE REBELLION SPREAD

Explain how a soldiers' mutiny at Meerut quickly grew into a massive rebellion joined by princes and ordinary people across northern India.

3. WHAT HAPPENED NEXT?

Explain how Britain crushed the rebellion with harsh punishment, abolished the East India Company, and gave direct control to Queen Victoria.

Sentence Starters & Connectives: Anger first broke out because... • This quickly spread across India when... • The turning point came when... • As a result, the British government decided to...

[P] Point: Clear sentence answering enquiry.

[E] Evidence: Specific facts from Page 12. **[E] Explanation:** Explain how and why this happened.

[L] Link: Link back to answer the question.

Handwriting practice lines for the extended writing section.

Teacher Assessment: Effort: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4] | Subject Knowledge: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4] | Disciplinary Analysis: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4]

PEEL Mastery: [] P [] E [] E [] L

L6: How did ordinary people fight for a voice?

CORE LEARNING OBJECTIVES:

- Explain the causes and violent aftermath of the 1819 Peterloo Massacre and the repressive Six Acts.
- Analyse the Hampshire Swing Riots of 1830 and the legal trial of the 1834 Tolpuddle Martyrs.
- Evaluate the methods and historical legacy of the Chartist movement between 1838 and 1848.

DO NOW: RECALL

Score: / 5

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CORE VOCABULARY

Complete the summary below using the terms *Franchise* and *Six Acts*:

When 60,000 peaceful protestors demanded the [] at St Peter's Field, the terrified elite responded by passing the repressive [].

Application: Explain why the magistrates were terrified of a French-style revolution:

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TASK 4: THE CRUCIBLE OF CLASS CONFLICT: REFORMERS VS. THE MANCHESTER MAGISTRATES (1819)

Contrast the stated aims of the peaceful working-class crowd against the paranoid fears of the ruling elite at St Peter's Field.

The Peaceful Reformers (Henry Hunt)

- Repeal of the hated 1815 Corn Laws causing mass starvation.
- Universal male suffrage & annual parliaments to end corruption.
- Dressed in Sunday best; women & children proudly marching.
- Banners demanding "Liberty and Fraternity" and "No Corn Laws".

👉 Synthesise their perspective in 2–3 sentences:

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The Manchester Magistrates (Elite Panic)

- Terror of a violent French-style Jacobin revolution in the North.
- Suspicion of military marching drill & revolutionary liberty caps.
- Panic reading of the Riot Act within 45 minutes of assembly.
- Ordering drunken cavalry to charge sabres drawn into the crowd.

👉 Synthesise their perspective in 2–3 sentences:

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Low-Floor Clue: Why were British landowners so petrified of mass gatherings in 1819, just 4 years after the defeat of Napoleon?

Enquiry: How useful is the Manchester Magistrates’ official report for an enquiry into the events of the Peterloo Massacre (1819)?

EXTENDED WRITING

1. CONTENT & CONTEXT

Explain what the magistrates claimed about 60,000 protestors marching in military drill, contrasting against your own knowledge of the peaceful Sunday crowd.

2. PROVENANCE (NOP)

Interrogate Nature, Origin & Purpose: Written by terrified Tory magistrates just 4 years after Waterloo, with the purpose of justifying their panic reading of the Riot Act and cavalry charge.

3. EVALUATIVE UTILITY

Give your final verdict: why is this report exceptionally useful for understanding elite paranoia, even if it is completely unreliable about the crowd’s peaceful intentions?

Sentence Starters & Connectives: In terms of Content, the magistrates report that... • However, contextual evidence proves that... • Evaluating Provenance, the Author’s Purpose was to justify... • Overall, the source is exceptionally useful for revealing elite panic rather than crowd violence.

[C] Content: Specific details from Source C.

[O] Own Knowledge: Corroborating historical context.

[P] Provenance (NOP): Author, motive, purpose, audience.

[U] Utility Verdict: Weigh strengths & limitations.

Handwriting practice lines consisting of 20 horizontal blue lines.

- Explain the corruption of the unreformed electoral system (Rotten Boroughs, pocket boroughs, open hustings).
- Analyse the 1832 Great Reform Act as a tactical compromise between aristocrats and the middle class.
- Evaluate how the 1872 Secret Ballot Act and the 1867/1884 Reform Acts laid the foundations for mass democracy.

Score: / 5

Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Q5

Distinguish between a depopulated **Rotten Borough** (e.g. Old Sarum) and an aristocratic **Pocket Borough**:

Track the escalation of the 1832 Reform crisis from parliamentary deadlock to the King's intervention below:

Rotten boroughs like Old Sarum (3 houses, 2 MPs) hold power, while industrial Birmingham has 0 MPs.

The House of Lords rejects the Reform Bill, sparking mass riots in Bristol and the burning of Nottingham Castle.

The "Days of May":
Reformers demand "Stop the
Duke, go for Gold",
threatening total collapse of
bank reserves.

King William IV threatens to create 50 Whig peers; the Lords surrender and pass the Great Reform Act.

Causal Analysis: In 3–4 sentences, explain why the threat of financial panic ("Go for Gold") and civil war forced the aristocracy to concede the vote to the middle class:

Page 16 of 20

Enquiry: Why was the Great Reform Act passed in 1832? Was it conceded out of fear of revolution or granted as a principled reform?

EXTENDED WRITING

1. FEAR OF VIOLENT RIOTS

Explain how working-class riots, burned castles, and threats to pull all money from banks pushed Britain close to a revolution.

2. THE GOVERNMENT'S PLAN

Explain why politicians passed the Act: giving the vote to middle-class men to keep them happy and stop them joining with workers.

3. WHAT WAS THE REAL REASON?

Give your judgment: did politicians pass the 1832 Act because they believed in democracy, or because they were scared of a civil war?

Sentence Starters & Connectives: One main reason for the Reform Act was... • Politicians were especially scared when... • On the other hand, the government wanted to... • In conclusion, Parliament only acted because...

[P] Point: Clear sentence answering enquiry.

[E] Evidence: Specific facts from Page 16.

[E] Explanation: Explain how and why this happened.

[L] Link: Link back to answer the question.

Handwriting practice lines consisting of 20 horizontal blue lines.

L8: Who truly benefited from 19th-century transformation?

CORE LEARNING OBJECTIVES:

- Analyse the "Optimist" argument using quantitative data on wages, public health, and technological innovation.
- Analyse the "Pessimist" argument regarding working-class slum squalor, alienation, and colonial economic extraction.
- Synthesize competing historiographical interpretations into a rigorous, balanced capstone enquiry essay.

DO NOW: RECALL

Score: / 5

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CORE VOCABULARY

Write one analytical sentence contrasting the historical claims of the **Optimist School** against the **Pessimist School** regarding living standards:

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TASK 4: THE GREAT STANDARD OF LIVING DEBATE: OPTIMISTS VS. PESSIMISTS

Complete the audit below, organizing the strongest historical evidence for each viewpoint.

The Optimist View (Things Got Better)

- Cheaper mass-produced clothes, soap, tea, and train travel.
- Wages slowly rose after 1850; new laws protected children.
- Created modern hospitals, schools, and democratic rights.
- Fewer famines and more reliable food supplies.

👉 Synthesise their perspective in 2–3 sentences:

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The Pessimist View (Things Got Worse)

- Cottage workers lost their independence and dignity.
- Dirty urban slums, stunted children, and deadly cholera.
- Huge wealth created by exploiting workers and colonies.
- Long, exhausting hours under the tyranny of the factory clock.

👉 Synthesise their perspective in 2–3 sentences:

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Low-Floor Clue: Distinguish between what happened to the first generation of factory workers (1780–1830) versus their

UNIT KNOWLEDGE VAULT & DISCIPLINARY COMMAND GUIDE

SCHOLAR
REFERENCE

KEY HISTORICAL FIGURES

- **James Watt (1736–1819):** Patented the separate condenser steam engine (1769).
- **Henry Cort (1741–1800):** Fareham ironmaster who invented puddling & rolling at Funtley (1783–84).
- **Isambard Kingdom Brunel (1806–1859):** Engineer of Great Western Railway & SS Great Britain.
- **Edwin Chadwick (1800–1890):** Author of landmark 1842 Sanitary Report.
- **Lord Shaftesbury (1801–1885):** Parliamentary champion of Ten Hours Act & Coal Mines Act.
- **Henry Hunt (1773–1835):** Radical orator at the 1819 St Peter's Field rally (Peterloo).
- **Earl Grey (1764–1845):** Whig Prime Minister who steered 1832 Great Reform Act.

THE 6 GCSE DISCIPLINARY COMMAND WORDS

- 1. Causal Weighting:** Prioritising multiple causes into triggers vs underlying pre-conditions.
- 2. Significance:** Judging historical importance using Scale, Duration, and Transformation.
- 3. Change & Continuity:** Distinguishing between radical turning points and persistent continuities.
- 4. Historiographical Debate:** Weighing competing academic interpretations with evidence.
- 5. Analytical Narrative:** Tracing causal links across an evolving sequence of events without story-telling.
- 6. Source Utility:** Interrogating Content, Context, and Provenance (NOP: Nature, Origin, Purpose).

Scholar Revision Checklist:

- | | | | |
|---|---|--|---|
| ☐ Energy & Cort | ☐ Industrial Work | ☐ Town Slums | ☐ British Empire |
| ☐ 1857 Rebellion | ☐ Peterloo Protest | ☐ 1832 Reform Act | ☐ Standard of Living |